

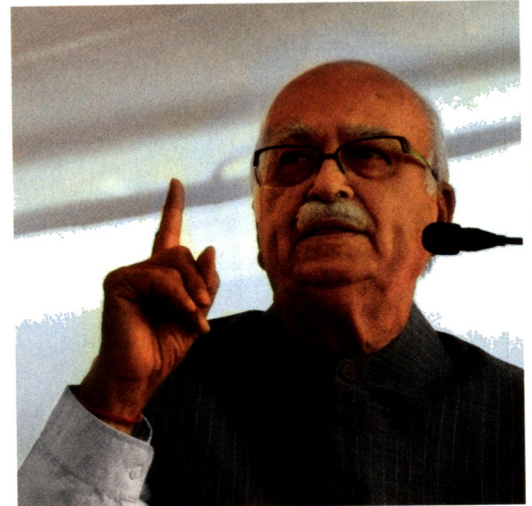
Remains of THE DAY

The commission of inquiry set up after the demolition of the Babri Masjid indicts 68, including Atal Bihari Vajpayee. A temporarily united BJP slams the report and the UPA Government says it will expedite existing cases. Ayodhya haunts politics again.

Politicking AS USUAL

The demolition of the Babri Masjid was a sin of commission. Thus surmised the Liberhan Commission of Inquiry report, observing that the demolition of the Babri mosque was a well-orchestrated move. However, instead of embarrassing the saffron leadership, the report has succeeded in uniting a beleaguered party. Torn between the moderate line and the RSS way, the BJP was at an ideological crossroads. Now Liberhan has ensured that Ram is back on the agenda with both the English-speaking moderates and the cowbelt leadership uniting to defend their leadership. The inclusion of former prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee as a pseudo-moderate along with L.K. Advani and Murli Manohar Joshi has outraged the party.

What is equally interesting is the name not mentioned. The then Congress Prime Minister P.V. Narasimha Rao has been given a reprieve. This, however, has only added to the



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What happened on DECEMBER 6, 1992

When nearly 5,000 kar sevaks pulled down the domes of Babri Masjid, they triggered off one of the biggest political upheavals in India. According to the Liberhan Commission report, the security apparatus was non-existent and the police ineffective.



10.30 a.m.

Advani, Joshi, Katiyar, Singhal and the sadhus reach the platform for the symbolic kar seva. They stay there for 20 minutes and go to Ram Katha Kunj where religious leaders had been making speeches.



12 p.m.

A teenage kar sevak breaches the outer cordon around the structure and climbs the dome. Around 150 kar sevaks follow him and storm the structure wielding pickaxes, hammers, shovels and iron rods.



12.15 p.m.

Nearly 5,000 kar sevaks begin an assault on the dome. Advani, Joshi, Singhal and Vijayaraje Scindia request them to come down from the structure. No one listens to them.

FORCES DEPLOYED IN AYODHYA

35 companies of Provincial Armed Constabulary (PAC)

195 companies of paramilitary forces (CRPF and ITBP) deployed outside Ayodhya

4 companies of CRPF including women's wing squad

15 tear gas squads

15 police inspectors

30 police sub-inspectors

2,300 police constables

Bomb disposal squad

Sniffer dog squads

Fire brigade

Ambulances



12.30 p.m.

Kar sevaks hurl bricks at security forces, attack media. District magistrate asks for paramilitary forces stationed around Ayodhya. Kalyan Singh agrees to deployment on condition they do not fire.